GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

April 25th, 2025
Week 17
Volume 271, Issue 1182

Highlights:

- **Uncertainty reigns.**
- **Momentum shift.**
- **Upgrades apace.**
- **Bangla deliveries?**
- **Turkish collapse.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"I would rather five people knew my work and thought it was good work than five million knew me and were indifferent."

– Colin Firth

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

PRECARIOUS!

As Team Trump finally concedes defeat and retreats on its tariff plans not only for the entire world, but also on China by confirming that the tariffs won't be "anywhere near the 145%" as originally tweeted. And while some saw a semblance of sanity pervading through, others are now suspecting 'market manipulation' to help the 1% and the masses are calling on the SEC to investigate Trump's actions during the week. As the drama played out, markets soared back only to start declining once again as the U.S. Treasury continues to see worrying trends of a massive sell-off of U.S. Dollars from various nations as faith in the financial stability of the U.S. starts to wane; but more importantly, a reported and ongoing sell-off of U.S. Treasury Bonds is causing a growing rift between the U.S. Treasury Secretary and the White House.

The flip flops from the White House are causing global markets to remain precarious too as freight and oil prices reversed course this week where charter rates jumped 1.5% by close of Friday while oil receded by over 1% ending the week at USD 63/barrel. Flip flops seem to be the theme of the week as OPEC+ countries too are reportedly seeing this week's version of the future from the White House and advocating for an accelerated output through June, as having met with Pres. Zelenskyy during the revered Pope Francis's funeral on Saturday, Trump commented that the Russia / Ukraine conflict now seems closer to reaching an agreement. Through it all, Team Trump's trade stance against China remains firm and as Pres. Xi acknowledges this very fact, it remains a dire time for the rest of us, especially when, if at minimum, auto and medicinal trade, finances, stock markets, school / college and retirement savings are going to be affected moving forward. At the broader end, student & intellectual migration and global tourism will collectively start to degrade, especially when the safety of not only those visiting other countries but even in their home countries, where visitors collectively become victims of political differences, the world may have truly slipped past President Trump's playful grip this week.

Although some momentum was generated in sub-continent markets over preceding weeks as the 90-day pause on tariffs was announced, ship recycling markets have remained cautiously stalled as the ambiguity around U.S. - China tariffs has maintained volatility on recycling nation steel plate prices & currencies, subsequently keeping vessel offerings & sentiments at the bidding tables, firmly in check. The ongoing restriction on issuing **any** No Objection Certificates (NOCs) in Bangladesh has also dragged on for another week, leaving Chattogram with no fresh arrivals even though some vessels did manage to find a way to delivery. Pakistan has disappeared into 'Empty Port Position' territory all while India's recently firming prices have helped it have the busiest anchorage of the week with nearly 40K LDT idling at Alang. Lastly, Turkey at the West End looks like its bottom fell entirely out this week as levels across the board (offers and fundamentals) fell sharply.

Overall, as the supply of tonnage has yet to fully pick up as we head into the summer months and with Easter Holidays across Europe now over, charter fixtures remain solid and will likely continue to deprive recycling markets of some much-needed tonnage for yet another week. It's already May 2025 next week folks!!

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 17 of 2025 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

HKC STUCK!

Inspections ongoing.

The Bangladeshi ship recycling sector came to a virtual standstill this week given that no fresh No Objection Certificates (NOCs) have been issued for over two weeks now, thereby suspending nearly all active negotiations with local recyclers on potential units currently at the bidding tables, in addition to the likely redirection of incoming units towards India / Pakistan range as only now are Bangladeshi authorities starting to inspect local ship recycling yards to ensure that the level of infrastructure upgrades needed towards attaining an HKC Statement of Compliance (SoC) by its gradually approaching deadline, had been initiated by the respective recyclers ever since the original deadline of January 31st to initiate such upgrades was extended to March 31st, and a 2nd extension now hangs in the balance.

Upgrades a must.

Before any further extensions will be considered or granted, especially to those facilities that have units idling outside or even on the way, that indeed the necessary infrastructure works have started and permissions on incoming units belonging to these recyclers could (hopefully) be granted allowing these units inside. But with the nation officially having confirmed to abide by the rules of the convention with its entry into force by June 26th, a mere 8 weeks away, the pressure is on the authorities to ensure the nation will deliver as assured and is the reason behind the seeming unwillingness of local authorities to 'play ball' with local recyclers. As a result, Chattogram has not reported any fresh arrivals of recycling units into Chattogram this week (on account of those pesky missing NOCs), all while a couple of last week's arrivals to recently approved SoC yards of which, there are reportedly a total of 7 thus far ,managed to deliver to their respective owners this week.

Approved / Rejected?

On the positive side, our Bangladeshi offices reported late Sunday that the Director General of Shipping did visit local ship recycling yards over the weekend and was pleased with the overall upgrades done so far, confirming that NOCs would be issued to certain yards with satisfactory progress. Although how many ship recycling yards with disproportionate degrees of upgrades stand to be given permissions and whether the vessels idling outside do indeed belong to this freshly approved (or yet to be rejected) batch, remains to be seen. On the worst-case scenario, any yard not yet HKC approved will have to wait to import vessels or display substantial progress of updates before they can continue operations and open future L/Cs.

Turbulent.

This has put a virtual pause on the domestic ship recycling industry whilst the results from the inspections (potential re-inspections for some) are completed. And with domestic fundamentals performing horrendously – local steel plate prices opening post Eid at USD 478/Ton (a whopping USD 61/Ton collapse from USD 529/Ton) and the Taka losing 10 basis points to close the week out at BDT 121.99 against the U.S. Dollar - the ongoing downtime may be worth the wait to see where these turbulent fundamentals eventually settle. For now, we well see Bangladesh's standing atop the market rankings come under threat from India, especially if Bangladeshi steel plate prices take another tumble in the coming week(s).

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

CONUNDRUM!

With Bangladesh's recent involvement at the bidding tables coming to a pause amidst their ongoing, slow-moving yard and NOC approvals and overall extension processes spanning the last two weeks over which, Indian ship recyclers jumped at the opportunity to step up and conclude a majority of the available market tonnage during this interim period. And with several small LDT, prompt delivery units being traded, this week's anchorage was a display of purchasing prowess blended with geographic convenience as 6 ships and nearly 40K LDT is currently idling at Alang.

NOC process drags.

However, volatility continues to reign in India as not only did declining (towards the end of the week) local steel plate prices manage to still end USD 1/Ton higher than last, but the Indian Rupee suffered through extreme volatility through the course of the week and ended it 5 basis point lower than last week, at nearly Rs. 85.40 against the U.S. Dollar. Moreover, the ongoing U.S. China tariff uncertainty and overall economic global tensions continue to rear their collective heads in India (and Pakistan) once again, leaving most in the ship recycling industry calling for calm unless (and until) the situation actually deteriorates.

Steel volatile.

Recent Pakistan-linked terrorist activity that also led to the deaths of several innocents in Northern India is seemingly escalating to a dangerous level between the two nuclear armed nations as India threatens a retaliatory suspension of water services into Pakistan from the Northwest of India, and extremist Pakistani politicians call for blood should India act on its threat. Amidst cancelation of student visas between the countries and other punitive retaliations, India is starting to build up a significant presence of armed forces along the Line of Control (LoC) against the claimed Paksitani border, as the threat of another potential war has certainly seen a recently stabilizing sentiment take a hit again, resulting in an overall decline in aggression to conclude even on a unit of local interest beyond safe margins, despite the overall economic state of the nation being in good standing.

Out of the fray.

Moreover, as Pakistani purchases retreat into the shadows and Bangladesh is still out of the fray, it is certainly upon Indian recyclers to make the most of this current situation and conclude whatever the market has to offer. What happens in May is a mystery waiting to unravel itself, with looming tariff whiplashes and reacting local fundamentals that could stand to up-end price levels and an overall lack of tonnage at the bidding tables. Ship owners could once again be chasing down the markets again, hoping the slide has ended.

Mystery May.

Finally, with monsoons around the corner and local yards being fully certified to HKC standards, Alang recyclers do have it comparatively easier than the regional competition is currently enduring.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

TRYING BUT FAILING!

Not taking chances.

There have been several opportunities for Pakistani ship recyclers to step into the ever-evolving spiral that has been the ship recycling industry so far this year, in order to secure their share of tonnage with aggression and firmer prices that were certainly higher than those from neighboring India over a recent few weeks. But Gadani buyers have regrettably been unable to secure much of the market tonnage over the past 3 quarters unto their dormant plots, tonnage that eventually ended up in competing Alang including this week, where Gadani expectantly and regrettably returned to an empty port position once again – a phenomenon that plagued local ship recyclers for well over 2 quarters between late 2024 – early 2025.

Pressing HKC.

And like India, Pakistani fundamentals certainly have a fair share of their effect on local sentiments as not only did local steel plate prices fall USD 10/Ton down to USD 624/Ton this week, but the Pakistani Rupee also continues to suffer as it fell dramatically to PKR 282.19 against the U.S. Dollar, only to eventually firm up and still end 16 basis points weaker than last week, at PKR 282.05. Moreover, as Chinese steel plate prices themselves firmed to and above USD 300/Ton this week and the future of tariffs hangs in the balance, should Pakistani steel levels continue to fall and Chinese levels continue to become more competitive, it may not bode well for Gadani ship recyclers as 2025 progresses, as local steel plate prices will come crashing down if there is no supply of steel / raw material from recycled ships and cheaper Chinese imports become more appealing to domestic steel mills.

Stark Notifier.

Moreover, even the domestic economy, though stable, remains a work in progress when compared to a recently firming India. And the possibility that we may see recycling tonnage heading towards Gadani shores in the coming days or even weeks, is now an increasingly diminishing probability. Notwithstanding, the more pressing matter of the moment remains around the pending HKC upgrades at Gadani yards, especially with all of the recently unfolding drama in Bangladesh via suspended entries for recycling units into Chattogram port limits, which should be a stark warning to Pakistani recyclers of what could happen to them in the next 8 weeks, should they fail to follow up with their own yard infrastructure works (that have reportedly barely begun) before the HKC enters into force on June 26th, lest they too face the same NOC hurdles post July 1st and as Bangladeshi recyclers are now going through.

Like Turkey!

Finally, as tonnage availability (even of regionally available units) increases (looking at you, Alang) monsoon remains a mere 5 weeks away, HKC kicks in a short 3 weeks hereafter, and hesitant ship owners unwilling to initially commit their units into Gadani will likely exacerbate the ability of Gadani buyers to procure tonnage through the last 2 quarters of the year, certainly leaving a bleak 2025 forecast for Pakistan, much like it could be for Turkey.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

BOTTOMS…BLOWN!!

Two-market industry

Turkey has endured a crazy 3 weeks whereby import and local steel plate prices have dropped by USD 52/Ton and USD 40/Ton respectively, having each declined a further USD 20/Ton this week as well. Not to be outdone, the Lira took its parachute off and jumped out of the plane, plummeting past a 1.6% decline this week and ending it at nearly TRY 38.50 against the U.S. Dollar.

And despite the 90-day tariff pause kicking into effect, Turkey's economy seems to be the one major ship recycling destination hit especially hard, with sentiments increasingly battered and Aliaga indications on prospective units dropping another USD 20/MT this week, the overall offer levels on bulkers / dry cargo vessels from Turkey now hitting USD 250/MT – a remarkable drop from only a couple of years ago when recycling vessels were being regularly concluded well into USD 400/MT to Aliaga recyclers.

And with sub-continent levels being steady overall, the now USD 200/Ton price differential will certainly be a hard pill for board members of publicly traded ship owning companies to swallow, should they consider the recycling route on their again beauties, thereby further alienating Turkish recyclers in the process. Like Pakistan, the remainder of the year seems like it might be destined to a two-market industry – shared between India and Bangladesh.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 17 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Static**	460 / LDT	480 / LDT	490 / LDT
2	India	**Improving**	455 / LDT	475 / LDT	485 / LDT
3	Pakistan	**Improving**	450 / LDT	470 / LDT	480 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Falling**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *In July, a cybersecurity company accidentally introduced a single software bug that canceled or delayed tens of thousands of flights and trains, halted surgeries, and blacked out television broadcasts around the world.*
- *Americans threw out four times as many small appliances in 2018 as they did in 1990.*
- *Luddites actually didn't hate technology.*
- *When a writer ran his own dissertation through the plagiarism-detection software that was likely used to help bring down Harvard President Claudine Gay, it initially claimed that his work was 74 percent copied. The correct number was zero.*
- *Classical composers used dice to randomly compose songs.*
- *Male birth control could soon be as simple as rubbing a gel on the shoulders and upper arms daily.*
- *Humans could find alien life by detecting fluorescent corals on other planets.*
- *In April, a red Tesla Model S became the first electric car to travel 2 million kilometers. The car could have traveled from the Earth to the moon and back, twice, then circled the equator 11 times.*
- *Blocking the sun can lower how hot a person feels by 36 to 72 degrees Fahrenheit.*
- *Termites bury fellow colony members that have been dead for a while. Fresh corpses, they devour.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
May 01 – Labor Day	April 26 – May 03 May 11 – May 17 May 24 – June 01

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
May 01 – May Day May 11 – Buddha Purnima	April 27 – April 30 May 11 – May 14 May 26 – May 29

BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
May 01 – 05 – Labor Day May 31 – June 02 – Dragon Boat Holiday	May 01 – Labor Day	May 01 – Labor & Solidarity Day May 19 Youth & Sports Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of April 25, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Auro*	*20,009*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered April 21*
2	*Gloun*	*3,199*	*Container*	*Delivered April 24*
3	*Kelsey 2 (Under Tow)*	*3,230*	*Chemical Tanker*	*Delivered April 20*
4	Lord 17	2,583	General Cargo	Arrived April 12
5	*Pasha 9*	*2,396*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered April 22*
6	Sea Sove	7,918	Bulk Carrier	Arrived April 24
Total Tonnage		**39,334**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of April 25, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Pilatus 22*	*974*	*LPG Tanker*	*Delivered April 20*
2	*Seaworld*	*5,534*	*RoRo*	*Delivered April 19*
		6,509		

GADANI - Port Position as of April 25, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No new vessels reported		
Total Tonnage		**-**		

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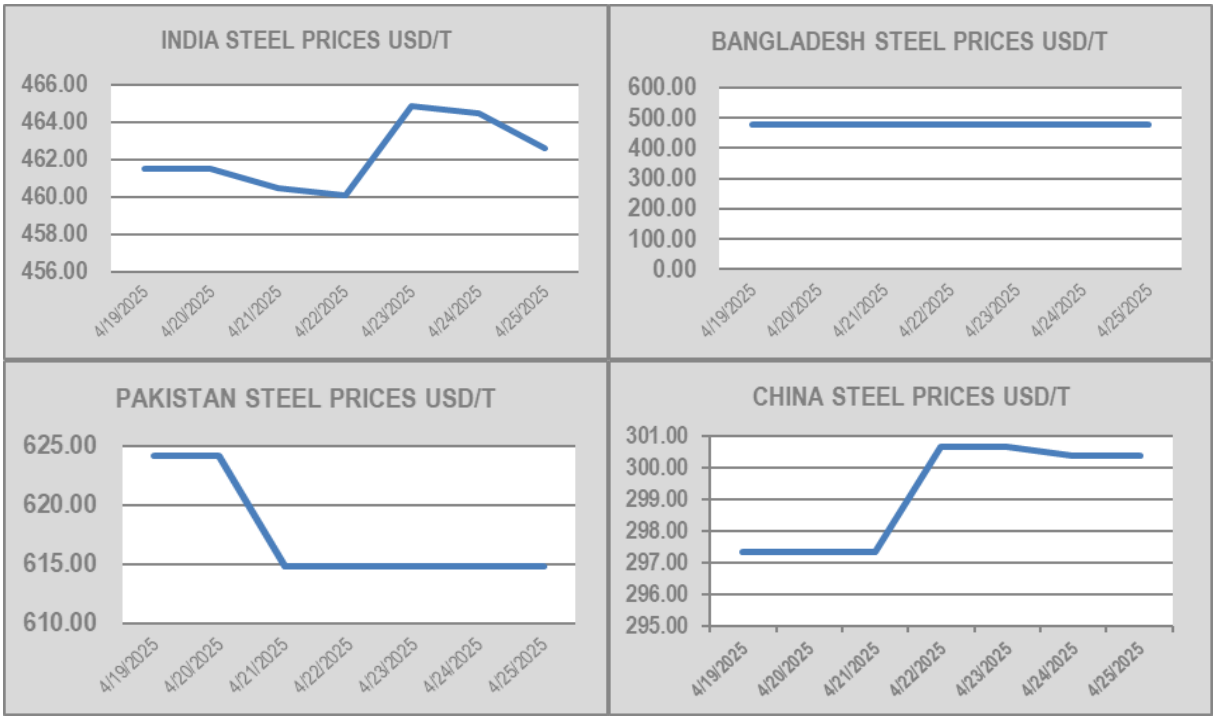
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
4/19/2025	461.52	39,400.00	624.22	175,000.00	478.55	58,000.00	297.37
4/20/2025	461.52	39,400.00	624.22	175,000.00	478.55	58,000.00	297.37
4/21/2025	460.47	39,200.00	614.78	173,000.00	478.55	58,000.00	297.37
4/22/2025	460.09	39,200.00	614.78	173,000.00	478.55	58,000.00	300.69
4/23/2025	464.87	39,700.00	614.78	173,000.00	478.55	58,000.00	300.69
4/24/2025	464.46	39,600.00	614.78	173,000.00	478.55	58,000.00	300.39
4/25/2025	462.62	39,600.00	614.78	173,000.00	478.55	58,000.00	300.39



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